

BTOProjects.sg

The definitive decision platform for Singapore's new-home journey

The opportunity

HDB provides authoritative facts. Property publishers provide launch-by-launch commentary. The open space is a persistent, structured and personalised product that helps a buyer answer: “Which project fits my life, and what should I do next?”

Recommended positioning

“Plan your HDB home with confidence.”

An AI-guided discovery and comparison experience, grounded in official data, with project pages that remain useful from early announcement through launch, construction, SBF and eventual MOP.

MVP FOCUS

Discovery + alerts

CORE MOAT

**Structured lifecycle
data**

INITIAL STACK

Next.js + Convex

Executive recommendation

Proceed — but do not build another BTO news site.

Build a living database and planning assistant. The winning product is not “all BTO information”; it is the fastest path from a buyer’s situation to a confident shortlist, with transparent evidence and alerts.

What to build first

- An interactive launch explorer: list + elegant map + timeline, filterable by town, region, MRT, price, flat type, waiting time, classification and launch status.
- Permanent project pages with one consistent schema: prices, flat mix, classification, wait time, transport, schools, amenities, site-plan observations, trade-offs, comparable resale transactions, source history and lifecycle status.
- A conversational planner that asks for budget, household profile, workplaces, parents’ location and wait tolerance, then ranks projects with explanations and links to evidence.
- Watchlists for projects, towns, MRT catchments and user-drawn areas; email/push alerts when HDB announces, launches, updates or offers relevant SBF inventory.
- A comparison workspace for two to four projects with commute, affordability, wait, amenities, restrictions and “what you give up” side by side.

What not to build in the MVP

- Precise ballot-odds predictions presented as certainty.
- Unverifiable stack-level “best unit” recommendations before sufficient site-plan data exists.
- A fully automated future resale valuation marketed as a promise.
- A heavy social network, forum or agent marketplace.
- Authentication before browsing; require sign-in only for saved preferences, alerts and personalised history.

1. Market landscape and opportunity

The market is active but fragmented across official pages, editorial launch reviews, transaction portals and community discussions. Users still assemble decisions manually across multiple tabs. This creates an opening for a product that standardises each project and carries it through its entire lifecycle.

Player	Strength	Weakness	User job served	Opening for BTOProjects.sg
HDB	Source of truth; application flow	Information architecture is transactional, not personalised	Verify and apply	Interpret, compare and alert while linking back to HDB

PropertyGuru / 99.co	Large audience; timely editorial coverage	Article-first; project history and comparison are inconsistent	Read launch news	Structured, evergreen project records and planning tools
Stacked Homes	Detailed launch and unit commentary	Manual editorial format; not a personalised database	Deep-dive before applying	Interactive filtering, saved profile and repeatable evidence model
Data.gov.sg / OneMap	Reusable official datasets and APIs	Raw data; no buyer journey	Look up facts	Normalise data into buyer-friendly answers
Reddit / Telegram / Facebook	Fast community sentiment	Noisy, ephemeral, hard to verify	Ask peers and gauge demand	Curated community signals with source confidence

Competitive verdict

The category is not empty; the product gap is.

Ranking number one for every broad BTO keyword will be difficult because HDB and major publishers have authority. A credible path exists through programmatic project/town pages, superior tools, alert loops and uniquely useful comparison pages. The target should be “most useful BTO decision product,” then organic leadership follows.

2. Users and search intent

Segment	Primary question	Product response
Early planner	“What is coming near my parents or workplace?”	Area watchlists, launch timeline, map, notifications
Active applicant	“Which launch should I apply for?”	AI shortlist, comparison, affordability, trade-offs
Specific-needs buyer	“Any upcoming 3Gen / short-wait / 5-room options?”	Flat-type and feature filters, saved search
Unsuccessful applicant	“Should I wait, try SBF or buy resale?”	Alternative path comparison and alerts
Post-booking owner	“What changed, when will it complete, what is nearby?”	Construction lifecycle, neighbourhood updates
Researcher / enthusiast	“How did this town’s launches and prices evolve?”	Historical explorer and downloadable summaries

High-value query families

- Upcoming intent: upcoming BTO 2026/2027, next BTO launch, BTO launch calendar, BTO near [town/MRT].

- Attribute intent: 3Gen BTO, 5-room BTO, short waiting time BTO, Standard/Plus/Prime BTO, BTO near primary school.
- Decision intent: [Project A] vs [Project B], best June/October BTO, should I apply for [project], BTO commute to [workplace].
- Financial intent: BTO price by town, grants, affordability, estimated monthly payment, BTO vs nearby resale.
- Lifecycle intent: [project] completion, construction progress, SBF availability, MOP date, expected neighbourhood changes.

3. Product strategy

North-star experience

One conversation, one living shortlist.

A user says: “We earn S\$10k, work in Changi and Buona Vista, parents are in Yishun, want a 4-room below S\$550k, and can wait four years.” The system turns this into constraints, shows a ranked shortlist, explains trade-offs, and lets the user follow projects or areas.

Primary navigation

- Explore — map, list and launch timeline.
- Upcoming — announced and likely future exercises, clearly separating official from inferred.
- Projects — every project, past and present.
- Compare — a persistent comparison tray.
- Planner — AI-guided recommendations.
- Watchlist — projects, areas and alerts.

Project-page blueprint

Module	Content
Decision summary	Who it suits, top strengths, key compromises, confidence and last-updated time
Official facts	Exercise, town, flat types, unit counts, price ranges, wait time, classification, restrictions
Location	Map, walking routes, MRT/bus access, schools, parks, food, healthcare, workplaces
Affordability	Upfront cash/CPF scenarios, mortgage range, grants links and assumptions
Comparables	Nearby resale transactions and town medians with filters and methodology

Site analysis	Orientation, road/noise exposure, facilities and site-plan observations — labelled as analysis
Lifecycle	Announcement → launch → application → construction → key collection → SBF → MOP
Source log	Official source links, extracted fields, update history and corrections

4. Feature prioritisation

Phase	Build	Why now	Defer / caution
MVP (6–10 weeks)	Project database; explorer; map; comparison; watchlists; email alerts; basic grounded chat	Creates indexable inventory and repeat use	No predictive pricing promises; no complex social layer
V1	Profile-based ranking; commute calculator; affordability scenarios; SBF tracker; project change log	Turns information into decisions	Keep recommendations explainable
V2	Draw-an-area search; “wait or apply?” scenarios; construction updates; richer site-plan analysis	Builds retention and differentiation	Require stronger data confidence
Later	Renovation/referral marketplace; agent handoff; premium reports; mobile app	Monetises established demand	Avoid degrading trust or neutrality

5. UX and visual design direction

Design principle

The site should feel closer to a calm financial-planning product than a property classifieds portal: spacious, evidence-led, map-forward and free of aggressive lead forms.

Element	Recommendation	Reason
Colour	Deep navy, teal, warm off-white, restrained coral for warnings	Trustworthy, modern and recognisably civic without copying government branding
Typography	Inter/Geist or a comparable clean sans; large numeric hierarchy	Excellent legibility on mobile and dense factual pages
Cards	Low-border, generous spacing, clear “official / estimated / analysis” badges	Prevents information overload and builds trust
Map	MapLibre renderer with a custom light basemap; project polygons as the dominant layer	MapLibre can look premium; styling and data layers determine the result

Mobile	Bottom sheet over map; sticky compare tray; full-screen planner	Avoid squeezing a desktop sidebar onto a phone
AI	Docked right panel on desktop; full-screen sheet on mobile; citations inside answers	Keeps chat contextual without hiding the underlying evidence

Map recommendation

Use MapLibre for interaction. Use OneMap for authoritative geocoding, routing and thematic data where licensing/terms permit. Do not assume OneMap tiles can simply be restyled: either use its available basemap styles or use a separate licensed/custom vector-tile source while overlaying OneMap-derived data.

6. Data acquisition and reliability

The core principle is provenance first: every field stores value, source URL, retrieved time, effective date, extraction method and confidence. AI may transform or summarise; it should not silently become the source of truth.

Data	Primary source	Method	Refresh	Notes
Launch/project facts	HDB sales exercise and project pages	Fetch + deterministic parser; AI fallback on changed layouts	Daily; hourly during launch week	Store snapshots and diffs
Upcoming exercises	HDB announcements/news releases	Structured extraction	Daily	Label dates/details as official only when published
SBF	HDB sales exercise inventory/pages	Fetch + parser	Daily during exercise	Do not “predict” exact units
Construction polygons	Data.gov.sg HDB under-construction GeoJSON	API/download ingestion	Weekly	Useful for project geometry and status
Resale transactions	Data.gov.sg HDB resale collection	API/download ingestion	Daily/weekly	Use for comparables, not guaranteed future value
Schools	MOE school directory on data.gov.sg	API/download + geocode	Quarterly/monthly	Calculate distance; avoid admissions claims
Routes/amenities	OneMap search, routing and themes	Authenticated API with caching	On demand + scheduled cache	Respect quotas and terms
Planning context	URA public plans and releases	Approved datasets/manual curation	Monthly	Separate adopted plans from speculation
Editorial analysis	Your own rules + LLM summarisation	Change-triggered enrichment	On source change	Publish assumptions and confidence

Ingestion pipeline

- 1. Scheduler triggers source adapters; adapters fetch with caching headers and rate limits.

- 2. Raw HTML/JSON/PDF snapshots are stored with hashes.
- 3. Deterministic parsers extract stable fields; schema validation rejects impossible values.
- 4. Only changed or unparsed sections go to an LLM for structured extraction.
- 5. A reconciliation job compares new facts with existing records and creates a review queue for material conflicts.
- 6. Approved changes publish atomically, invalidate caches and trigger relevant alerts.
- 7. Every page shows “last verified” and a human-readable source trail.

7. AI architecture and safeguards

DeepSeek V4 Flash is a plausible low-cost conversational model, but model choice should remain swappable. Treat the LLM as an interface and analyst over a governed dataset, not as the database.

Layer	Recommended approach	Guardrail
Query understanding	Extract constraints into a typed profile	Show/edit interpreted preferences
Retrieval	Structured Convex queries first; semantic retrieval for long text	Never answer project facts from model memory
Ranking	Transparent weighted score + LLM explanation	Expose why each project ranked; let users change weights
Estimates	Statistical baseline from comparable transactions; LLM writes narrative	Publish range, date, assumptions and uncertainty
Answering	Cited response with links to project/source records	Refuse or qualify when data is missing/stale
Model routing	Cheap model for chat/extraction; stronger fallback for complex synthesis	Log quality, latency and cost by task

Do not call it a valuation.

Use language such as “scenario estimate” or “comparable-based range.” A disclaimer helps, but the product should also show methodology, comparable count, geography, time window and uncertainty. Trust comes from transparent limits, not legal text alone.

8. Recommended technical architecture

Stack verdict

Next.js + Vercel + Convex is enough for the MVP.

You do not need AWS at launch. Add specialised infrastructure only when a measured bottleneck appears. The main architectural requirement is separating ingestion/background work from user-facing rendering.

Layer	Choice	Comment
Frontend	Next.js App Router on Vercel	SEO rendering, fast iteration, image optimisation, route-level caching
Database/backend	Convex	Projects, profiles, watchlists, source records, jobs and realtime updates
Auth	Clerk with Google sign-in	Fast account flow; browse without login, gate saves/alerts only
Maps	MapLibre GL JS	Custom UX, polygons, catchments, draw tools and vector overlays
Government geo	OneMap APIs	Search, routing, themes and localised authoritative data
Email	Resend or Postmark	Transactional alerts and digest emails
Scheduler	Vercel Cron initially; Convex scheduled functions where appropriate	Daily/hourly ingestion without separate cloud account
Raw snapshots	Vercel Blob / Cloudflare R2 later	Keep source artefacts and hashes outside primary records
AI	Provider abstraction; DeepSeek V4 Flash as initial option	Avoid lock-in and route tasks by cost/quality
Analytics	Vercel Web Analytics first	Add PostHog only when funnels/experiments justify it
Monitoring	Sentry + structured job logs	Detect parser failures and source changes quickly

When AWS becomes justified

- Large-scale geospatial processing or tile generation.
- High-volume crawling with long-running workers that exceed serverless limits.
- Heavy document/PDF processing and durable queues.
- Cost or compliance requirements that make managed serverless services inefficient.

9. SEO and discoverability strategy

The SEO moat is structured coverage plus useful tools. Avoid generating thin pages for every keyword combination. Each indexable page must answer a distinct intent and contain original computed or curated value.

Page family	Examples	Unique value
Launch exercise	/bto/october-2026	All projects, dates, filters, comparison and updates
Project	/projects/bayshore-vista	Permanent fact record, map, analysis, comparables and lifecycle

Town	/bto/tampines	Past/upcoming projects, price history and town guide
MRT/area	/bto/near-woodlands-mrt	Walking-distance projects and upcoming watchlist
Attribute	/bto/3gen or /bto/short-waiting-time	Verified inventory plus educational guidance
Comparison	/compare/project-a-vs-project-b	Original side-by-side computed table
Tools	/affordability, /commute, /launch-calendar	Interactive intent capture and backlinks
Guides	/guides/hfe, /guides/sbf	Evergreen explanations with official links

Technical SEO requirements

- Server-render critical page content; do not hide facts behind chat or client-only map interactions.
- Use canonical URLs, stable project slugs, XML sitemaps by content family and breadcrumb schema.
- Add structured data cautiously: Article/FAQ where valid, BreadcrumbList and Dataset where appropriate; do not fabricate ratings.
- Preserve historical project pages and redirect renamed projects rather than deleting them.
- Publish source dates, update logs and author/reviewer information to strengthen trust.
- Create internal links from launch → project → town → comparison → guide, with contextual anchor text.
- Build embeddable charts/tables and concise, citation-friendly summaries for AI search engines.

10. Monetisation model

Monetisation should follow trust. The user is making a high-stakes housing decision; aggressive lead capture will damage the brand before it compounds.

Model	Timing	Potential	Risk/control
Mortgage / HDB-loan education referrals	After meaningful traffic	High-value lead economics	Clearly label sponsorship; never alter rankings
Renovation / defects / moving referrals	Post-booking lifecycle	Natural timing and repeat relevance	Vet partners; user-initiated contact only
Premium planning workspace	After retention is proven	S\$4–12/month or one-off report	Free core facts; charge for convenience, history and scenarios
Sponsored town/project content	Later	Brand revenue	Strict separation from editorial and official facts
Display advertising	Late / selective	Simple but lower quality	Avoid intrusive ads on decision screens

Data/API products

Long term

B2B recurring revenue

Respect source licences and
derived-data rights

Recommended sequence

- Phase 1: free product + email alerts; validate acquisition and repeat usage.
- Phase 2: contextual partner referrals after the user explicitly asks for financing, renovation or conveyancing help.
- Phase 3: paid “Home Plan” with unlimited comparisons, scenario history, household collaboration, custom area alerts and downloadable reports.
- Phase 4: anonymised/aggregated market intelligence or API access, subject to source licences and privacy review.

11. Launch roadmap and metrics

Sprint	Outcome	Acceptance test
Weeks 1–2	Schema, source adapters, design system, 10 representative projects	Every field has provenance; mobile project page works
Weeks 3–4	Explorer, map, launch/town/project routes, search and filters	User finds a suitable project in under two minutes
Weeks 5–6	Comparison, auth, watchlists, email alerts	User can save an area/project and receive a test change alert
Weeks 7–8	Grounded planner, ranking rules, analytics and SEO hardening	Answers cite records; no uncited project facts
Weeks 9–10	Historical backfill, editorial QA and public launch	At least 50–100 high-quality permanent pages; parser monitoring live

North-star and diagnostic metrics

- North star: percentage of active users who create a shortlist or watchlist after viewing project evidence.
- Activation: first comparison, first saved profile, first alert subscription.
- Quality: source freshness, extraction error rate, correction rate, answer citation coverage.
- Retention: users returning for a new exercise, source update or alert digest.
- Acquisition: non-brand organic clicks to project/town/tool pages and email subscription conversion.
- Monetisation: partner-intent actions per engaged user, not raw lead-form submissions.

12. Principal risks and mitigations

Risk	Failure mode	Mitigation
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Source fragility	HDB layouts and documents can change	Snapshot, hash, schema validation, parser tests and manual review queue
Trust / liability	Predictions may be mistaken	Separate fact/estimate/analysis; ranges and methodology; no guarantees
SEO dependence	Large publishers can outrank new domains	Tools, alerts, unique datasets, internal links, community distribution and email retention
API quotas / terms	OneMap and other services have limits	Cache, batch, monitor quotas and maintain fallbacks
Model risk	Cost, availability or hallucination	Provider abstraction, retrieval-first architecture and deterministic checks
Privacy	Profiles include income/work/family locations	Minimise collection, encrypt sensitive fields, granular deletion and clear consent
Overbuilding	Large vision delays launch	Ship the permanent project database and watchlists before advanced predictions

13. Final product recommendation

Position BTOProjects.sg as the buyer's planning layer above official data.

The first release should make every project easy to discover, compare, understand and follow. The AI should reduce cognitive load, not replace evidence. The durable moat is the clean project lifecycle dataset, user preference graph, change history and alert relationship — not the language model itself.

The three signature features

- Personalised launch shortlist: a transparent ranking built from budget, commute, family proximity and waiting-time preferences.
- Follow any place: project, town, MRT catchment or drawn boundary, with alerts when relevant official information changes.
- Lifecycle project record: one canonical page from rumour-free official announcement through BTO, construction, SBF and MOP.

One-sentence MVP

A beautiful map-and-list explorer of every BTO project, with evidence-rich pages, comparison, a grounded planner and alerts for projects or areas.

Sources and research notes

Key public sources reviewed. Access dates are 2 August 2026 unless otherwise stated. Product recommendations and competitive conclusions are analytical judgments based on these sources and the observed user journey.

1. HDB, February 2026 BTO and SBF exercise announcement

<https://www.hdb.gov.sg/sitecore/content/hdbinfoweb/home/hdb-pulse/news/2026/hdb-launches-9012-flats-in-february-2026-bto-and-sbf-exercises>

2. OneMap API documentation

<https://www.onemap.gov.sg/apidocs/>

3. OneMap routing API documentation

<https://www.onemap.gov.sg/apidocs/routing>

4. Data.gov.sg, HDB Public Housing Building Under-Construction

https://data.gov.sg/datasets/d_930e662ac7e141fe3fd2a6efa5216902/view

5. Data.gov.sg, resale flat prices from Jan 2017 onwards

https://data.gov.sg/datasets/d_8b84c4ee58e3cfc0ece0d773c8ca6abc/view

6. Data.gov.sg, HDB resale price collection

<https://data.gov.sg/datasets?agencies=HDB&resultId=189>

7. Data.gov.sg, median resale prices by town and flat type

https://data.gov.sg/datasets/d_b51323a474ba789fb4cc3db58a3116d4/view

8. Data.gov.sg, MOE general information of schools

https://data.gov.sg/datasets/d_688b934f82c1059ed0a6993d2a829089/view

9. 99.co, Singapore Property News / BTO coverage

<https://www.99.co/singapore/insider/>

10. Stacked Homes, June 2026 BTO launch review

<https://stackedhomes.com/june-2026-bto-launch-review/>

11. Associated Press, DeepSeek V4 model launch overview

<https://apnews.com/article/d2ed33f2521917193616e061674d5f92>

Important implementation notes

- Confirm source terms, robots rules, API quotas and Open Data Licence obligations before production ingestion.
- “Upcoming” pages must distinguish official announcements from modelled or editorial expectations.
- The DeepSeek model and pricing landscape is fast-moving; benchmark latency, quality, Singapore context and data-handling requirements before committing.
- This report is product and market strategy, not legal, financial or housing eligibility advice.